

AAKARSH ANAND

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OBJECTIVE

Large-scale machine learning and statistical modeling. Currently, I am working on applications of AI/ML in biomedical data, particularly developing foundation models for high-dimensional clinical data. I am also interested in developing efficient computational methods to deepen our understanding of complex human traits and diseases. I have recently published in Nature Genetics and Genome Research.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Computer Science

Sep 2024 – Present

UCLA | Los Angeles, CA

Major Field: Artificial Intelligence

Minor Fields: Data Science Computing, Computational Systems Biology

B.S. in Computer Science

Sep 2020 – Jun 2024

UCLA | Los Angeles, CA

EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Researcher

Jan 2022 – Present

Advisor: Sriram Sankararaman | UCLA

- Devising foundation models for wearable time-series data to enable personalized health insights (in progress)
- Developed a scalable algorithm for detecting pairwise interaction effects between genetic variants on a trait in biobank datasets (*Genome Research*, RECOMB 2024)
- Leveraged a randomized method of moments statistical framework to build an algorithm for efficient variance component estimation in biobank datasets (*Nature Genetics*)

Software Engineering Intern

Jun 2023 – Sep 2023

LabCorp | Burlington, NC

- Designed and implemented reproducible/efficient Snakemake pipelines to analyze adenovirus and phage genetic sequencing data

Research Intern

Jun 2022 – Sep 2022

Bruins in Genomics Summer Program | UCLA

- Applied interpretable machine learning strategies to improve understanding of non-linear models of genetic data

Research Assistant

Jan 2021 – Apr 2022

Advisor: Paul Boutros | UCLA

- Implemented new alignment method (HISAT2) in cancer sequencing pipeline and redesigned configuration file for ease of use (*Cell*)
- Benchmarked pipeline performance in downstream tasks, created new documentation and diagrams

PUBLICATIONS

- Fu, B.*, Anand, P.*, **Anand, A.***, Mefford, J., & Sankararaman, S. (2024a). A scalable adaptive quadratic kernel method for interpretable epistasis analysis in complex traits. *Genome Research*.
<https://doi.org/10.1101/2024.03.09.584250>
- Fu, B., Pazokitoroudi, A., Xue, A., **Anand, A.**, Anand, P., Zaitlen, N., & Sankararaman, S. (2023a). A Biobank-scale test of marginal epistasis reveals genome-wide signals of polygenic epistasis. *Nature Genetics*.
<https://doi.org/10.1101/2023.09.10.557084>
- Patel, Y., Zhu, C., Yamaguchi, T. N., Wang, N. K., **Anand, A.**, et al. (2024). Metapipeline-DNA: A Comprehensive Germline & Somatic Genomics Nextflow Pipeline. *bioRxiv*.
<https://doi.org/10.1101/2024.09.04.611267>

AWARDS

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|---|--------------------------|
| • Warren Alpert AI and Computational Biology Fellow | Jun 2024 |
| • Dean’s Honors List UCLA | All quarters 2020 – 2023 |
| • NSF REU Scholarship Bruins in Genomics | Aug 2022 |
| • Andy Grove Intel Scholarship Intel | Aug 2020 |

TEACHING AND MENTORSHIP

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| Teaching Assistant | Winter, Spring 2025 |
| Samueli School of Engineering UCLA | |
| • AI for Computational Genomics (CS CM121/221) | |
| • Machine Learning Applications in Biomedicine (DS BMED 205) | |

SKILLS

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|-------------------|--|
| Technical | Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Statistics, Probabilistic Models, Pipelines |
| Frameworks | PyTorch, Sci-kit Learn, NumPy/Pandas, Git |
| Languages | Python, C++ |